

PAUSE WITH YOU

A multisensory ritual device for
reimagining the smoking pause

Preserving the ritual of pause without nicotine or
combustion

HUMAN FACTORS · PHYSICAL PRODUCT DESIGN



A personal observation became a design question

“Watching an exhaled plume disperse appeared to contribute to my sense of pause and relaxation.”

What functions does smoking perform beyond nicotine delivery—and which could be transformed without reproducing harmful exposure?

OBSERVATION

Not general evidence

I treated lived experience as a starting point—not a conclusion about other smokers.

Smoking is an interaction among four dimensions

01

Pharmacology

Nicotine delivery, dependence, craving and withdrawal.

02

Sensorimotor

Holding, hand-to-mouth movement, inhalation, exhalation and tactile feedback.

03

Ritual

Leaving an activity, initiating a sequence, repeating cycles and reaching an ending.

04

Contextual

Stress, boredom, meals, social situations and the perceived permission to pause.

DESIGN SCOPE

Pause with You focuses on sensorimotor and ritual functions. It does not attempt to treat nicotine dependence.

The evidence revealed a productive contradiction

FAMILIARITY MAY HELP

Behavioral substitutes may matter more for smokers who value handling and manipulation.

Non-nicotine sensorimotor stimuli can influence short-term craving and behavior.

RESEMBLANCE MAY TRIGGER

Visual and multisensory smoking cues can provoke craving and influence subsequent behavior.

A closer copy is not automatically a better substitute.

Design implication · Preserve the function. Transform the form.

I decomposed a cigarette into a sequence of functions



PRESERVE

pause · manipulation · visible completion ·
clear ending

TRANSFORM

lighting → twist / smoke → responsive
visual mist

REMOVE

tobacco · combustion · nicotine delivery · inhaling through the object

How might a physical product preserve the tactile ritual, pause and visible completion of smoking—without requiring combustion or nicotine delivery?

Preserve agency

The user can start, repeat or stop at any time.

Separate input from exposure

Breath can control the product without inhalation through it.

Make breath visible

Exhalation should produce an immediate, legible response.

State uncertainty

A cessation intention is not proof of cessation effectiveness.

Evidence became explicit product requirements

R1 No tobacco, combustion or nicotine delivery

R2 Inhaled air remains dry; generated mist is downstream of exhalation

R3 A short cylindrical power-grip form—not a cigarette-like silhouette

R4 Exhalation controls visible mist in real time

R5 Every interaction has a clear start, cycle and ending

R6 Recommendations remain adjustable and non-coercive

R7 No claim of validated cessation effectiveness

R8 Leaks, heat, contamination and misuse default to shutdown

These requirements describe a concept—not an engineering validation record.

Pause with You turns exhalation into a visible ending

01 Breath sensing

A circular mouthpiece preserves oral ritual while one-way valves separate inhale and exhale.

02 Mist response

A rear outlet makes exhalation visible behind the closed fist.

03 Tactile ritual

A microphone-like power grip creates a deliberate, stable pause gesture.

04 Storage case

A removable mouthpiece and reservoir support cleaning and maintenance.

Form language

short cylindrical · closed-fist grip · matte charcoal · circular mouthpiece · rear mist outlet

Breath, water and control follow separate paths

INFORMATION

Exhalation → external sensor → controller → mist / light / haptics

WATER

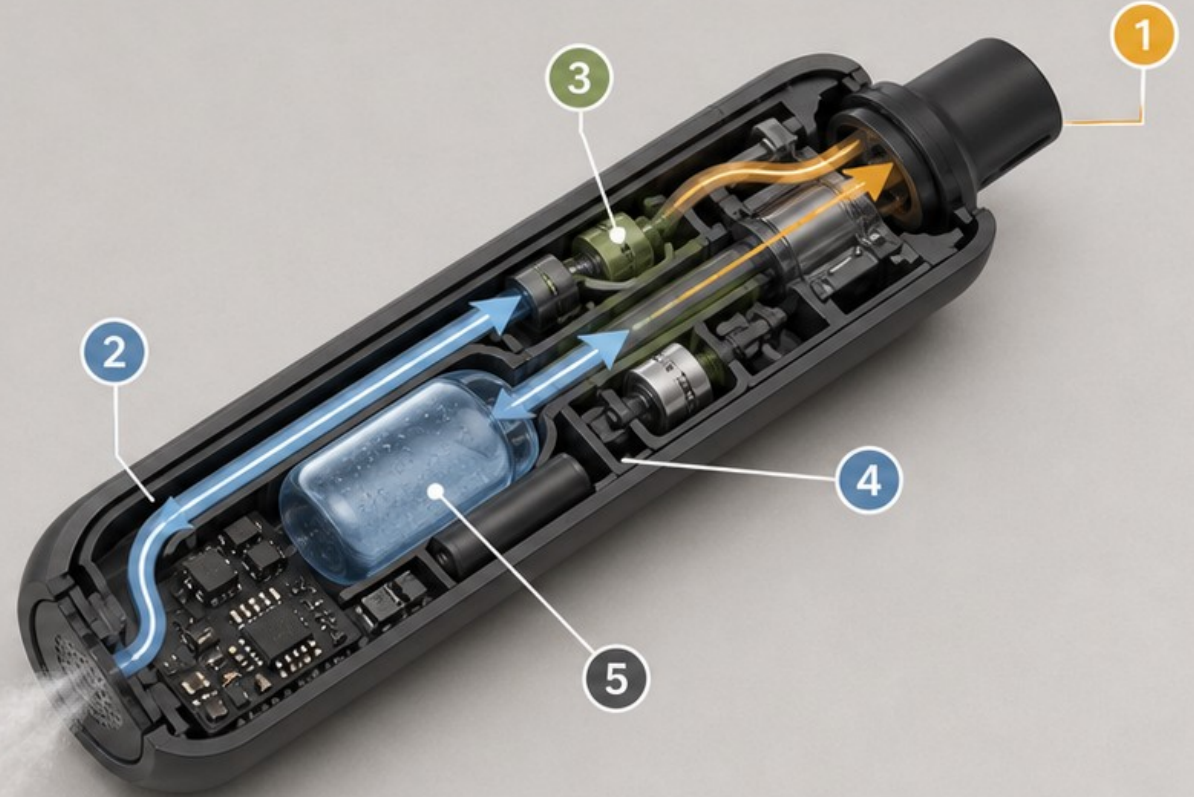
sealed reservoir → micro-feed → mist chamber → condensation return

USER AIR

ambient inhalation → user exhalation → external sensor surface → room

Closed model principle · Only the sensing signal crosses between pathways.

One exterior, five separated pathways



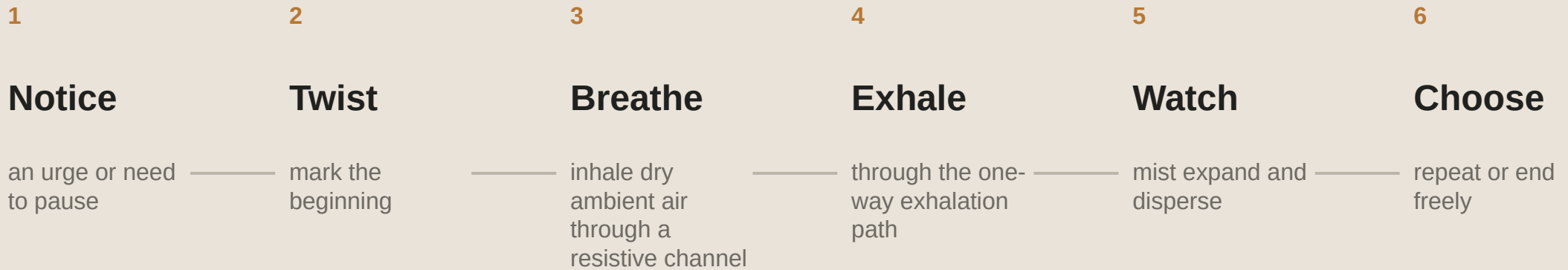
EXTERIOR

the final closed-fist, microphone-like form

CUTAWAY

illustrative architecture—not engineering validation

The product structures a pause without grading the user



No pass/fail breathing target

A short or irregular exhalation still receives feedback. The system supports agency rather than turning respiration into performance.

Safety changes the architecture—not just the disclaimer

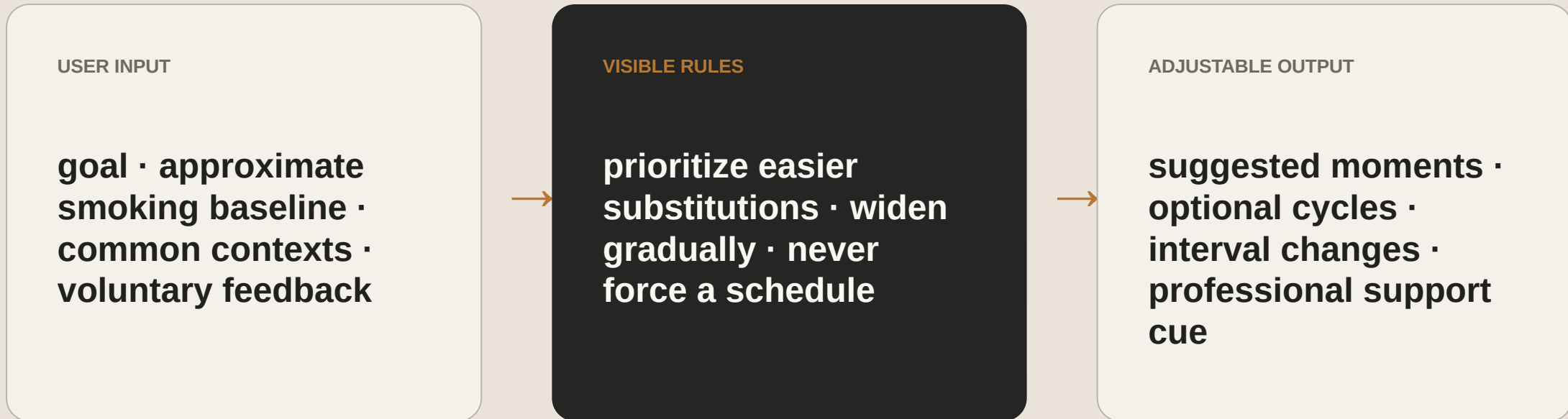
CLOSED

- **No inhalation through the object**
The sensing surface and internal water path remain separate.
- **No external water-mist emission**
Condensation is collected within a sealed module.
- **Faults default to shutdown**
Leaks, temperature, contamination and battery faults stop mist generation.

AMBIENT

- **Water aerosol is still an exposure**
“Only water” does not establish inhalation safety.
- **Maintenance becomes safety-critical**
Water quality, microbial growth, cleaning and storage affect emissions.
- **Claims must remain separate**
Ambient cannot inherit Closed’s no-emission claim.

Personalization is transparent, adjustable and secondary



Concept boundary

The system does not predict cessation success, diagnose dependence or replace professional care.

A concept can demonstrate reasoning. It cannot substitute for evidence.

Visual mist

Does it create completion, relaxation—or a stronger smoking cue?

Form similarity

Does familiarity ease transition or maintain conditioned behavior?

Closed architecture

Can mist, condensation and hygiene remain stable at portable scale?

Cessation outcome

Does use change smoking behavior beyond the immediate interaction?

Future work would require engineering tests, exposure characterization and appropriately reviewed user research.

The outcome is not a safer cigarette.

It is a framework for deciding what to preserve, what to transform and what must be removed.

Psychology → system

I translated lived experience and behavioral evidence into physical requirements.

Contradiction → decision

I treated familiarity and cue-reactivity as a design tension, not an inconvenience.

Safety → interaction

I used exposure pathways, foreseeable misuse and claim boundaries to shape the product.

Concept → next question

I stated what remains unknown and what evidence would be needed next.